

CDN Incident Alert: 0042. TLP: CLEAR		Date	Breakout Scale
Title	DE	Doppelgänger continues on X, new domains and sharing authentic articles. 30/01/2024	2

Summary

- Between 9 January and 19 Jan, Russian influence operation “Doppelgänger” published 573 tweets resharing articles (authentic and inauthentic) in French, Polish, Ukrainian, Hebrew and German.
- The German narratives focused on trying to cause concerns around financial issues in Germany.
- One new domain was registered and authentic articles started being amplified again. Otherwise, no change in behaviour.
- European Governments and X have been alerted.

Incident

Between 9 January and 19 Jan, Russian influence operation “Doppelgänger” published 573 tweets resharing articles (real and fake) in French, Polish, Ukrainian, Hebrew and German. Out of these tweets, 167 tweets repurposed real articles for the benefit of the influence operation.

Given the upcoming German elections, the narrative section of this alert focuses on the narratives promoted in the German dataset.

Technical issues prevented effective monitoring of all Doppelgänger-affiliated tweets during this time period, but the prevalence of real articles repurposed for the influence operation could nonetheless be noted clearly.

It should be noted that content of the tweets did not always correspond clearly to the articles shared in the tweet. For example, a tweet about the struggles of a German tourist agency was shared on twitter with a post regarding the folly of supporting Ukraine.

Out of the range of fabricated articles produced by DG, four were German, and one were new: grunehummel(.)net, targeting the Green topics (with previously seen wanderfalke(.)net, welt(.)pm and spiegel(.)bz also seen).

Beyond the German fake domains, the following were used: news(.)walla(.)top, leparisien(.)fyi, wanderfalke(.)net, grunehummel(.)net, welt(.)pm, obozrevatel(.)ltd, unian(.)cx, lepoint(.)top, lesfrontieres(.)media.

Real outlets reposted were: Rzeczpospolita (Polish), Wpolarity (Polish), Fronda (Polish), Dziennik (Polish), bfmtv (French), Sueddeutsche Zeitung (German), merkur (German), Handelsblatt (German), Zeit (German), HNA (German), Cyfrowa (Polish), Radio marijya (Polish), La Depeche (French), Heidelberg 24 (German), Wiadomosci Gazeta (Polish), Gazeta Olsztynska (Polish), Le Figaro (French), Focus (German), Le Point (French), Onet (Polish), Le Journal du Dimanche (French), Bankier (Polish), Caseur (French), and France TV Info (French).

Narrative

German economy is weak; once-strong German companies are now failing; Regular citizens lose their jobs and banks do not care; German car industry is weak; Retirement waves will cause worker shortages in Germany; all German parties are fiscally irresponsible; Demand is falling for electric vehicles; Ukraine is losing.

Impact

According to Twitter’s API, the tweets garnered a total reach of 1,627,968 views (NB: This data is unreliable).

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [Distort](#) – The operation takes genuine articles reposting them with a framing that suits the operation’s narrative

Objective: [Smear](#) - Smear German governments and Ukraine.

[Post Inauthentic Social Media Comment](#) - SDA quote tweets their posts to comment on other users' posts.

[Develop Inauthentic News](#) – The operation also generates fabricated articles purporting to be published by reputable news sources to spread false narratives

[Domain Asset](#) – The influence operation is using look-alike domains to give legitimacy to the influence operation.

[Conduct Server Redirect](#) - The posts contain redirect URLs that obfuscate them to avoid content moderation.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Report all tweets and involved accounts to EU Authorities and to X on January 28 2025.

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
N/A	German Elections, Financial concerns, Ukraine	Dataset upon request	Joel Haglund, Alliance4Europe	X	